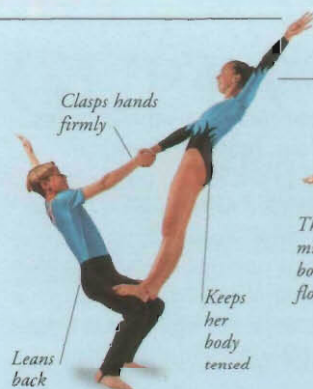
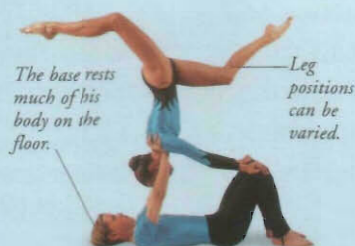


Gymnastics

Sports acrobatics



Counterbalance: gymnasts use their weight against each other.



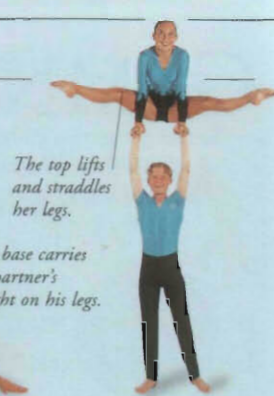
Shoulder balance: a simple, stable position.



Simple balance: the base supports the top.



Stag balance: elegance contrasts with strength.



Straddle lever balance: an advanced position.

Rhythmic sequences



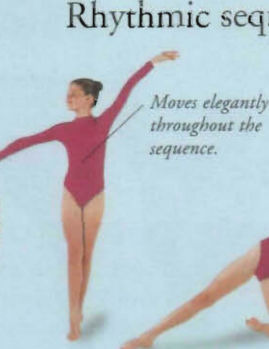
1 Swings hoop around the waist.



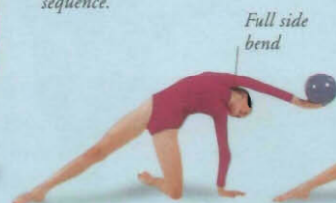
2 Lets a side of the hoop drop.



3 Jumps through the hoop.



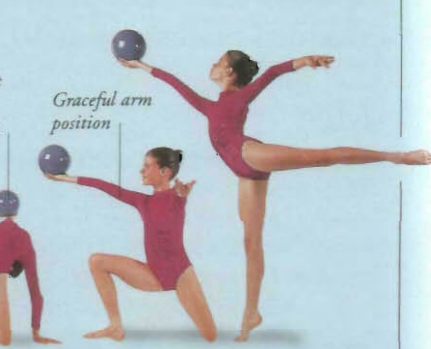
4 Carries hoop to the side.



1 Carries the ball to one side.



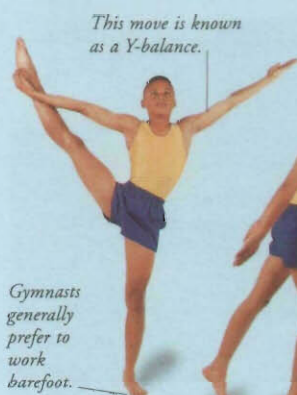
2 Circles the ball out behind.



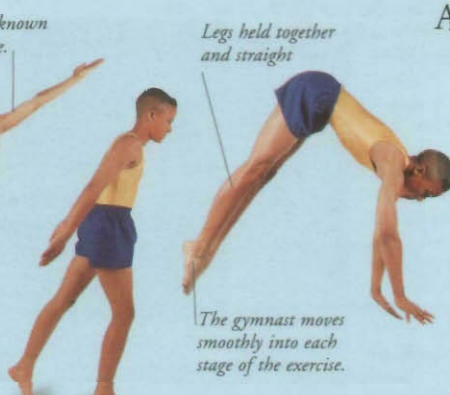
3 Spirals to the other side.

4 Rises into an arabesque.

Artistic, floor

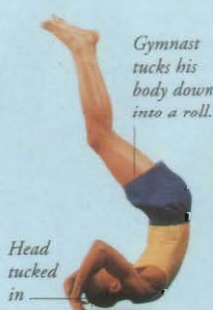


1 Gymnast holds balance for two seconds.



2 Springs into a dive.

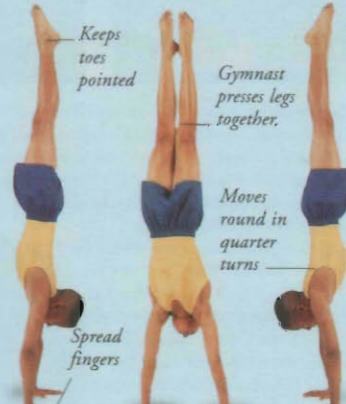
3 Upwards and forwards into a dive roll.



4 Lands on hands and rolls.



5 Rolls onto feet and comes up to stand.



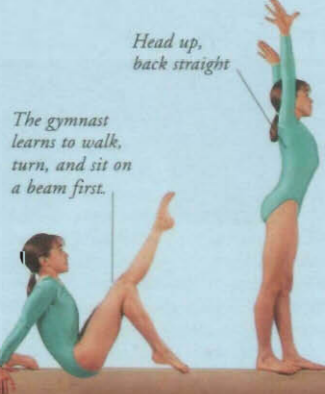
6 Kicks up to a handstand, then turns round by moving his hands.

Artistic, beam

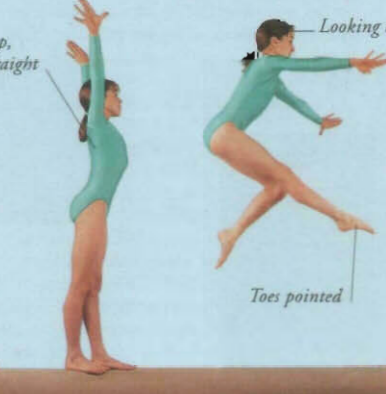
The **beam**, used only in women's gymnastics, is very difficult. For safety's sake, a gymnast must progress from floor skills, to a low beam, then a practice beam.



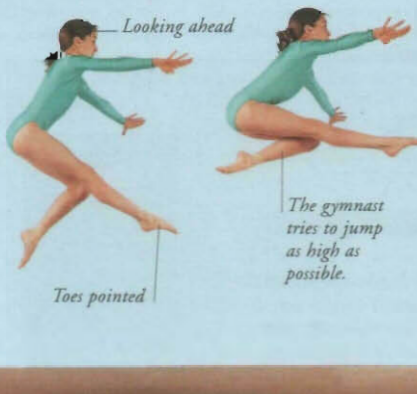
1 Gymnast mounts the side or end of the beam.



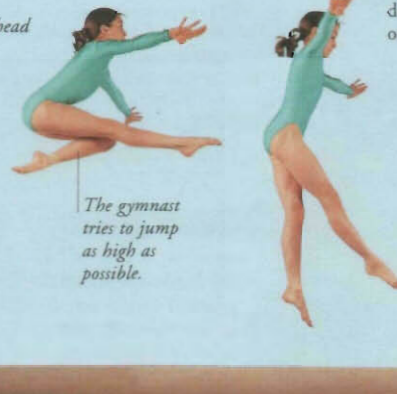
2 Performs low move, known as a V-sit.



3 The gymnast begins a W-jump.



4 With one step, takes off from both feet.



5 She points one leg forward and tucks the other behind.



6 Prepares to land.

In competition, judges deduct points for wobbly or faulty landings.

She bends her knees as she lands.

7 She keeps a steady balance.